

Pluto, moons, and asteroids

The dwarf planet Pluto is so small and so distant from Earth that we cannot get a good look at it—even with the most powerful telescopes. Pluto has five moons—the largest is called Charon, which is about half its size. There are about 170 other moons in the Solar System, 69 of them living with Jupiter. Mercury and Venus are the only planets without any moons.

Small world

Pluto is really tiny—much smaller than Earth's Moon. It is a freezing and dark world of ice and rock. The Sun is so far away that Pluto gets hardly any heat and light from it.

Some scientists think Pluto was once a moon of Neptune that got knocked out of its orbit.



From Pluto, the Sun would look like just another bright star.